



New-age rivalry: Jannik Sinner and Carlos Alcaraz have shared eight of the past nine Grand Slam titles between them. AP

crowd. Why is that? Didn't the crowd support you even in defeat? One can understand making space for the winner to enjoy the applause and ovation, but not even acknowledging the fans with a wave does appear somewhat ungracious.

Be that as it may, it was a terrific fortnight of high-quality tennis, with plenty of upsets in the first week alone, as many seeded players were knocked out. The unusually hot weather made life tough for some players, particularly those featuring in their first Major and having to play five-set matches. Other tournaments use a best-of-three format, so suddenly coming to a Major and facing two additional sets if a match

goes the distance is a true test of physical fitness and stamina, and only the super fit come through.

The first three Majors of the year have made it clear that the era of Alcaraz and Sinner has well and truly begun, with the two sharing the titles between them for the second year in a row. Sinner now has two, while Alcaraz, following in the footsteps of Rafa Nadal, claimed the French Open on clay. The last Major is the US Open on a hard court. Will Sinner continue his domination there, or will Alcaraz — or even Novak Djokovic — find new wind and upset the Numero Uno tennis player in the world?



One of the things that has become noticeable in recent times is the increasing dependence of top players on their coaching and support staff.